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1. Project Title

Pastimes Web-Based Clothing Management System

2. Introduction

The Pastimes system is a web-based application designed to manage user access and display clothing products. The system simulates a real-world environment where users must register, be approved by an administrator, and then gain access to system features. The project demonstrates core web development principles including authentication, database integration, and access control.

3. Objectives

- To develop a functional login and registration system
 - To implement role-based access control (admin vs user)
 - To integrate a MySQL database with a PHP application
 - To display dynamic product data from the database
 - To simulate a real-world approval workflow
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4. System Overview

The system follows a client-server architecture where users interact with the application through a web browser. PHP handles server-side logic, while MySQL stores and retrieves data. The system ensures that only authorized users can access protected resources.

5. System Features

5.1 User Registration

Users enter their details to create an account. All new users are assigned a *pending* status until approved.

5.2 Authentication (Login System)

The system validates user credentials against the database. Passwords are encrypted using MD5 for basic security.

5.3 Admin Approval Workflow

An administrator reviews and approves or deletes user accounts. Only approved users can log in.

5.4 Session Management

Sessions are implemented to:

- Maintain user login state
- Restrict unauthorized access
- Redirect users appropriately

5.5 Role-Based Access Control

Users are assigned roles:

- **Admin:** Full system access
- **User:** Limited access

5.6 Product Management (Display)

Products are dynamically retrieved from the database and displayed with relevant details such as name, brand, price, and image.

6. Technologies Used

- PHP (Backend logic)
 - MySQL (Relational database)
 - HTML & CSS (User interface)
 - XAMPP (Local development environment)
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7. Database Design

The system uses a relational database called **PastimesDB**.

Entity Relationship Overview (ERD Explanation):

- One table stores users (**tblUser**)
- Another table stores products (**tblClothes**)
- Each table has a primary key for unique identification

tblUser Attributes:

- userID (Primary Key)
- fullName

- email
- username
- password
- status
- role

tblClothes Attributes:

- itemID (Primary Key)
 - itemName
 - brand
 - price
 - image
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8. System Architecture

The system follows a layered structure:

- **Presentation Layer:** HTML interface (forms, pages)
- **Application Layer:** PHP scripts (logic, validation)
- **Data Layer:** MySQL database

This separation improves maintainability and scalability.

9. Security Considerations

Although basic security is implemented, the system includes:

- Password hashing (MD5)
- Session-based authentication
- Restricted page access
- Role-based authorization

Limitations:

- MD5 is not fully secure for production systems
 - No input sanitization (risk of SQL injection)
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10. Testing and Results

The system was tested using the following scenarios:

- User registration → successful
- Admin approval → functional

- Login validation → accurate
- Session protection → enforced
- Unauthorized access → blocked

All major functionalities performed as expected.

11. Challenges Faced

- File path and server configuration issues
 - PHP syntax errors and debugging
 - Session handling and redirection logic
 - Database connection troubleshooting
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12. Solutions Implemented

- Correct folder structure in XAMPP
 - Debugging using error reporting
 - Proper session initialization
 - Consistent database configuration
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13. Evaluation

The system meets its objectives and demonstrates:

- ✓ Functional authentication system
- ✓ Database-driven application
- ✓ Role-based control
- ✓ Dynamic data handling

However, improvements can be made in security, user interface, and scalability.

14. Recommendations for Improvement

- Use stronger password hashing (e.g., bcrypt)
 - Implement prepared statements to prevent SQL injection
 - Improve UI using modern frameworks (Bootstrap)
 - Add product search and filtering
 - Implement user profile management
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15. Conclusion

The Pastimes system successfully demonstrates the development of a dynamic web application using PHP and MySQL. It integrates authentication, database management, and role-based access control into a functional system. The project provides a strong foundation for more advanced web development and reflects practical understanding of backend systems.

16. How to Run the System

1. Copy the *Pastimes* folder into:
C:\xampp\htdocs
 2. Open phpMyAdmin and import:
PastimesDB.sql
 3. Start Apache and MySQL in XAMPP
 4. Open browser and go to:
<http://localhost/Pastimes/php/login.php>
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17. Screenshots

Included in submission:

- Login Page
 - Registration Page
 - Admin Panel
 - Dashboard
 - Products Page
 - Database Tables
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